

THAN DUC THANG

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Senior Game Designer

Systems · economy · live-ops · hybrid-casual design with a product owner's eye

Creative game designer, passionate about crafting experiences that stay meaningful to players. Four years across VNG, Amanotes, and XGame designing concepts, systems, and economies for titles with 1.5M+ combined downloads, while building the work process and AI-assisted workflows whole teams create with.

EXPERIENCE

XGame Studio Senior Game Designer

2026

Mid-sized studio (~200 staff) taking its first steps into hybrid-casual; brought in to instill big-studio design fundamentals, process, and AI-assisted workflows.

- Lead Game Designer on Catdom: Color Hole (live hybrid-casual — **500k+ downloads, six-figure lifetime IAP revenue, 50%+ D1 retention**): own the improvement backlog with the PO, design level curves, and facilitate a 5-designer team through testing and level-tuning sessions
- Key Game Designer on Color Blast: Block Shooter (**1M+ downloads, seven-figure lifetime IAP, 70%+ D1**): ran level A/B-tests, set the level-curve direction, and lifted engagement significantly
- Designed **1,000+ levels** across four titles (Color Blast, Catdom, Color Flow, Carnival Blast)
- Standardized the GD process now **adopted company-wide across ~10 projects**: Level Design standards, ideation and kick-off templates, and a data-driven metrics workflow; especially **AI-assisted pipelines (Claude)** for level generation and automated metrics reports the team uses daily
- Run the **GD internship program end-to-end**: screened and interviewed 50+ applicants, then mentored 4 interns through to final review

Amanotes PTE. LTD. Game Designer

2024 - 2025

Leading music-game publisher with 3B+ downloads worldwide. Converted hyper-casual titles into long-term hybrid-monetization products.

- Built Cat Dash's economy from scratch, defining the monetizable item set (skins, songs, hearts, coins, boosters) and full source-to-sink flows to take the title from ad-only to hybrid IAP+IAA (**100k+ downloads**; the only new title of its cohort to pass prototype and soft-launch gates)
- Hypothesized shorter levels fit modern play sessions, then **designed and ran the A/B test and rolled out the winning variant**, restructuring the entire level format
- Redesigned the level journey around player feeling: an easy-hook opening rising along a **sawtooth difficulty curve** (Kishōtenketsu pacing). Also designed the **Battle Pass** (exclusive song-pack Chapters) and a coin-based player shop

VNG Corporation Game Designer

2022 - 2024

Entered through the ZPS Game Designer Fresher Program, VNG's only hiring path for game designers: a multi-gate, 6-month intensive in concept, system, data-driven, and live-ops design.

- Pitched the real-time match-3 concept **greenlit into production as Tinkle Crush – Match 3 RPG**; designed core gameplay, power-ups, blockers, enemy systems
- Adapted Trix, a traditional Saudi card game, for MENA through cultural research, Arabic-first UI/UX, and IP character ideation with a local consultant: **4.7★ (797 ratings), Top-3 Card game on Google Play MENA in launch week**
- Project design lead on ZingPlay World, the studio's most ambitious social-sim world: coordinated a **5-designer team** and personally designed **10 levels in 3D** (suspended for technical reasons)
- Mentored 4 fresher designers** (2023–2024); all 4 passed every gate, were hired, and remain with the company today

SKILLS

- Concept & ideation**: new-genre exploration, pitch-to-greenlight concepts (one original match-3 greenlit into production), ideation frameworks
- AI-assisted design**: Claude & Gemini — level-generation pipelines, automated metrics reports, AI-augmented GD workflows
- System & economy design**: resource flows, hybrid monetization (IAP+IAA), Battle Pass, offers & live-ops, data-driven design loop (hypothesize → test → improve)
- Leadership & mentoring**: 5-GD team facilitation, internship program design, 8 mentees across 2 companies
- Tools**: Figma, Photoshop, Illustrator, Unity (prototyping), spreadsheet-based balancing

EDUCATION & AWARDS

B.Sc. Information Technology, National Economics University (2018–2022) · MindX Fullstack Web Development (Gen 1) · English: APTIS C1

Vietnam Global Game Jam · boardgame category, 4 consecutive years: **1st (2024)** · 2nd (2023) · 3rd (2026)